

10.2 THE PAST CONTINUOUS FOR SCENE-SETTING

The past continuous is often used in storytelling to set a scene or describe a situation.



It was a beautiful day.
The sun **was shining** and the birds **were singing**.
Children **were laughing** and **playing** in the street.

10.3 THE PAST CONTINUOUS AND THE PAST SIMPLE

When English uses the past continuous and past simple together, the past continuous describes a longer, background action, and the past simple describes a shorter action that interrupts the background action.

CONTINUING BACKGROUND ACTION

INTERRUPTING MAIN ACTION

I **was taking** a photo when **a monkey grabbed** my camera.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

He **was sunbathing** when it **started** to rain.



She **was sleeping** when the phone **rang**.



I **was mowing** the lawn when you **called**.



I **was having** a bath when you **knocked**.

